

LEO CLUB VICE PRESIDENTS TRAINING

2025 / 2026

Leo District 306 D7 | Leadership - Experience - Opportunity

Leos of Sri Lanka
& Maldives
► INSPIRING LIVES



AGENDA

- 01** Introduction to Lions and Leo
- 03** Role of the Vice President
- 05** Running Meetings as VP
- 07** Working with Exec Committee
- 09** Case Studies and Key Takeaways

- 02** Club Organizational Structure
- 04** Supporting the Club President
- 06** Representing Your Club
- 08** Getting Started and Year Planning

THE LIONS AND LEO MOVEMENT

Lions Clubs International (LCI)

- Founded by Melvin Jones (1879-1961) - world's largest service organization
- 1.4 million members in 46,000+ clubs | Slogan: We Serve | Founded 1917
- Mission: Vision, Hunger, Environment, Pediatric Cancer, Disaster Relief

Leo Club Program

- Founded December 5, 1957 - youth wing of LCI for ages 12-30
- 7,200+ Leo Clubs in 150+ countries | Motto: Leadership - Experience – Opportunity
- Develops leadership, planning, and social skills through community service

Leo Multiple District 306 - Sri Lanka and Maldives

- Redistricted in 2005 into 6 districts: A1, A2, B1, B2, C1, C2
- Leo District 306 D7: One of the most active Leo Districts in Sri Lanka

CLUB ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

Club President - The Leader

- Sets overall direction and tone for the entire club year

VICE PRESIDENT - Your Role

- Second-in-command; supports, assists, and steps in for the President

Leo Advisor

- Provides Senior Lions guidance on all club activities

Staff Advisor

- Institutional/faculty advisor providing administrative support

Immediate Past President

- Ensures continuity; serves as institutional memory resource

Secretary and Assistants

- Handles communications, minutes, reports, and records

Treasurer and Assistants

- Manages finances, budget, dues, and financial reporting

Board of Directors

- Core governing body that approves decisions and drives projects

Past Presidents

- Advisory council - mentorship and institutional knowledge

Members

- The heart of the club - participants in all service projects

ROLE OF THE VICE PRESIDENT - GENERAL

The VP as the Presidents Key Support

- You are the second most senior leader - the presidents trusted right hand
- Understand the purposes and ethics of Leo club fully; share the presidents vision
- Your words and actions set the tone for the club alongside the President

Core Responsibilities

- Be a positive role model - an example of a true Leo leader at all times
- Help the president define annual goals with the board of directors
- Assist in preparing detailed agendas for every meeting with the secretary
- Vice-Chair all club meetings - make members feel involved and appreciated

Delegation and Outreach

- Help appoint committee chairpersons with the president; provide clear guidelines
- Help maintain communication with the sponsoring Lions Club and Leo Advisor
- Encourage members to take on new roles and engage beyond club level

SUPPORTING THE CLUB PRESIDENT

When the President Is Present

- Act as Vice-Chair - support the president in running all meetings
- Assist in keeping discussions focused and time-bound
- Back up the presidents decisions while offering constructive input
- Manage member engagement - ensure no one feels left out

Stepping Up When Needed

- Assume the presidents role immediately when he/she is absent
- Lead projects, meetings, or events with the same authority and standards
- Keep the president fully informed upon their return

Goal Setting and Planning

- Co-develop the years goals with the president and board
- Track progress against goals and flag risks early
- Offer a second perspective on key decisions - be a sounding board

The VP as Future President

- Use this role as your apprenticeship for the presidency
- Observe, learn, and absorb everything about running the club
- Begin identifying your own vision for when your time comes
- Groom yourself through every project, meeting, and challenge

RUNNING MEETINGS AS VICE PRESIDENT

BEFORE the Meeting

- Assist in identifying objectives - is this meeting truly necessary?
- Help confirm date, time, and venue convenient to most attendees
- Ensure agenda and notices are sent well in advance

DURING the Meeting

- Arrive early - help ensure setup is fully complete before members arrive
- Greet everyone who comes in; make all members feel welcome
- Start on time; assist the president in sticking to the agenda
- Record or coordinate minutes and action items (very important!)
- Maintain order; step in to chair if the president steps out

AFTER the Meeting

- Help circulate minutes at the earliest opportunity
- Follow up on action items assigned to members
- Assist in sending thank-you notes to contributors
- Remind members of the next meeting date

VP Meeting Best Practices

- Meetings should never exceed 60 minutes (ideally 45 min)
- Three Phases: Plan - Execute - Follow Up
- Never leave the chairmans seat empty - you fill it when needed
- Speak clearly; avoid jargon; be inclusive in discussions

REPRESENTING YOUR CLUB OUTSIDE

You Are a Key Face of Your Club

- You are one of the main representatives and image-bearers of your Leo Club
- How you communicate and behave directly reflects the Leo Club and its future
- Your actions carry significant weight - every interaction matters

Standards of External Conduct

- Be Responsible - own your role and your members conduct at all times
- Be Respectful - in tone, language, and approach with all stakeholders
- Communicate Clearly and Effectively - represent the club with professionalism
- Maintain Your Standards - never compromise the Leo Clubs image

Who You Interact With Externally

- Other club members and Club Presidents across the district
- Council Officers, District Executive Committee, Multiple District officials
- Lions Club leaders and the sponsoring Lions Club

WORKING WITH THE EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE

The VP as a Team Builder

- You and the club executive committee should function as one unit - one family
- Unity is the foundation of every successful club activity and project
- You should be an active aid to the president as the binding force of this family

Fostering Team Culture

- Compliment and award your members regularly - recognition drives motivation
- Motivate them individually - understand what drives each committee member
- Include them in decisions - every voice matters in the executive committee
- Maintain effective, open, and two-way communication at all times
- Delegate effectively - match tasks to strengths and follow up consistently

Resolving Conflict

- Conflicts will arise - address them swiftly, fairly, and privately
- Listen to all sides before drawing conclusions; remain neutral and objective
- Escalate to the president only when necessary; aim to resolve at your level

GETTING STARTED - FIRST STEPS AS VP

Before You Take Office

- Attend Club Officer Training to fully understand your responsibilities
- Meet with the current president - discuss ongoing matters and your support role
- Set personal goals aligned with the clubs overall presidential vision

Financial and Administrative Setup

- Assist the president in working with the treasurer on the club budget
- Help prepare administrative and activities budgets for the year
- Support the selection of banking institution and petty cash guidelines
- Help establish club dues to maintain the clubs financial health

Ongoing Term Responsibilities

- Help conduct regular board meetings and general meetings
- Communicate frequently to keep members up to date on club matters
- Handle correspondence within 24 hours - maintain a 24-hour response standard
- Assist in selecting and planning service projects for the year
- Support new member recruitment campaigns actively
- Attend zone meetings alongside the president
- Review monthly membership and activity reports for performance tracking

CASE STUDIES - VP IN ACTION

Scenario: President Absent at a Club Project

- Step up immediately - assume full leadership responsibility without hesitation
- Brief the team confidently; assign roles and proceed as planned
- Keep the president informed throughout; document all decisions made

Handling Problems That Arise

- Stay calm under pressure - your composure sets the tone for the team
- Identify the root cause before acting; consult senior members if needed
- Communicate transparently - members respect honesty over false reassurance
- Document what happened and debrief with the president afterward

Resolving Member Conflicts

- Listen to both sides separately and without judgment first
- Find common ground - focus on what both members share as Leos
- Mediate calmly; propose a fair resolution and follow through
- Escalate to the president only if resolution is not achievable

Reflection Questions for New VPs

- How will you promote the Leo mission in your community?
- What are your top goals for your term as Vice President?
- How will you support your president while growing as a future leader?
- What kind of club culture do you want to help build?

YOU ARE A KEY LEO LEADER

Support. Step Up. Inspire. Prepare for the next chapter.

SUPPORT

Be the presidents trusted right hand.

STEP UP

Lead with confidence when called upon.

GROW

Prepare yourself for the presidency ahead.

Be the senior you needed when you were a junior. - Leo District 306 D7